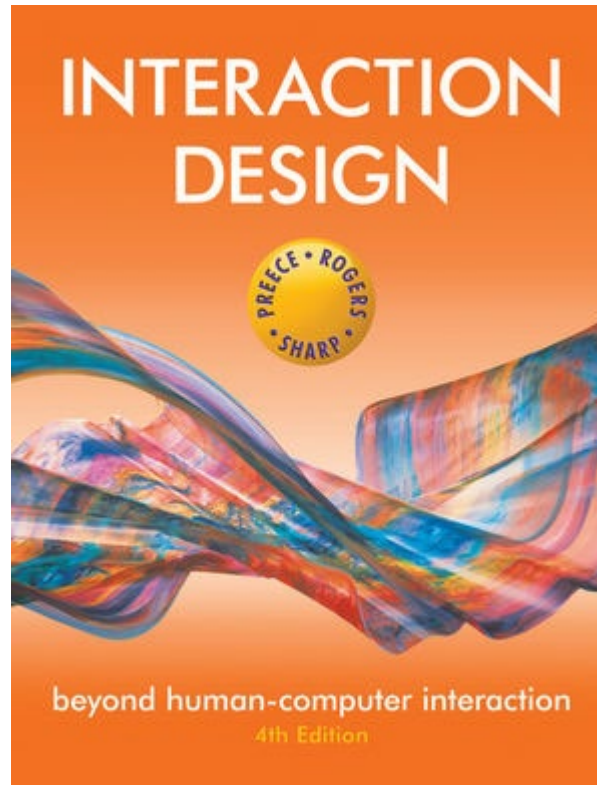




Chapter 1

WHAT IS INTERACTION DESIGN?

Dr. Sab V. Babu

Bad designs

Elevator controls and labels on the bottom row all look the same, so it is easy to push a label by mistake instead of a control button



Image Source: www.baddesigns.com

People do not make same mistake for the labels and buttons on the top row. Why not?

Why is this vending machine so bad?



Image Source: www.baddesigns.com

- Need to **push button first** to activate reader
- Normally **insert bill** first before making selection
- Contravenes well known convention

Good design

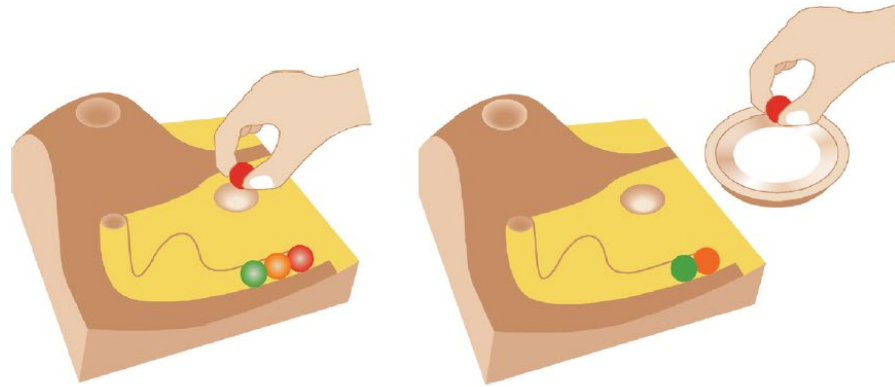


Figure 1.1 The marble answering machine

Source: Adapted from Gillian Crampton Smith: "The Hand that Rocks the Cradle" *ID Magazine*, May/June 1995, pp. 60–65.

- Marble answering machine (Bishop, 1995)
- Based on how everyday objects behave
- Easy, intuitive and a pleasure to use
- Only requires one-step actions to perform core tasks

Good and bad design

- Why is the TiVo remote so much better designed than standard remote controls?
 - Peanut shaped to fit in hand
 - Logical layout and color-coded, distinctive buttons
 - Easy to locate buttons

See:

<http://gizmodo.com/5017972/story-of-a-peanut-the-tivo-remotes-untold-past-present-and-future>

Dilemma

Which is the best way to interact with a smart TV?

- Standard remote device?
- Apple slimline remote control?
- Minnum's new keyboard?



Images Source: <http://minuum.com>